of the concept, not least through their observation of orchids. Like many other flowering plants, orchids rely on insects to pollinate them. Some have extraordinary structures in which to hold nectar and pollen. To lure the insect pollinators, the plants offer them a drink of energy-giving nectar. This fascinated Darwin, who was given a specimen of the Madagascar orchid in 1862. The flower stores its nectar in a hollow spur nearly 12 in (30 cm) long. Darwin and Wallace speculated that only a large moth could have a proboscis long enough to reach the nectar—a theory eventually proven in 1997. If the orchid's spur were shorter, a moth could drink without picking up pollen and so would not pollinate the flower. If the spur were longer, a moth would not visit.